# Cultural Heritage in FAIRyland?

*How to LODify geodata in QGIS?*

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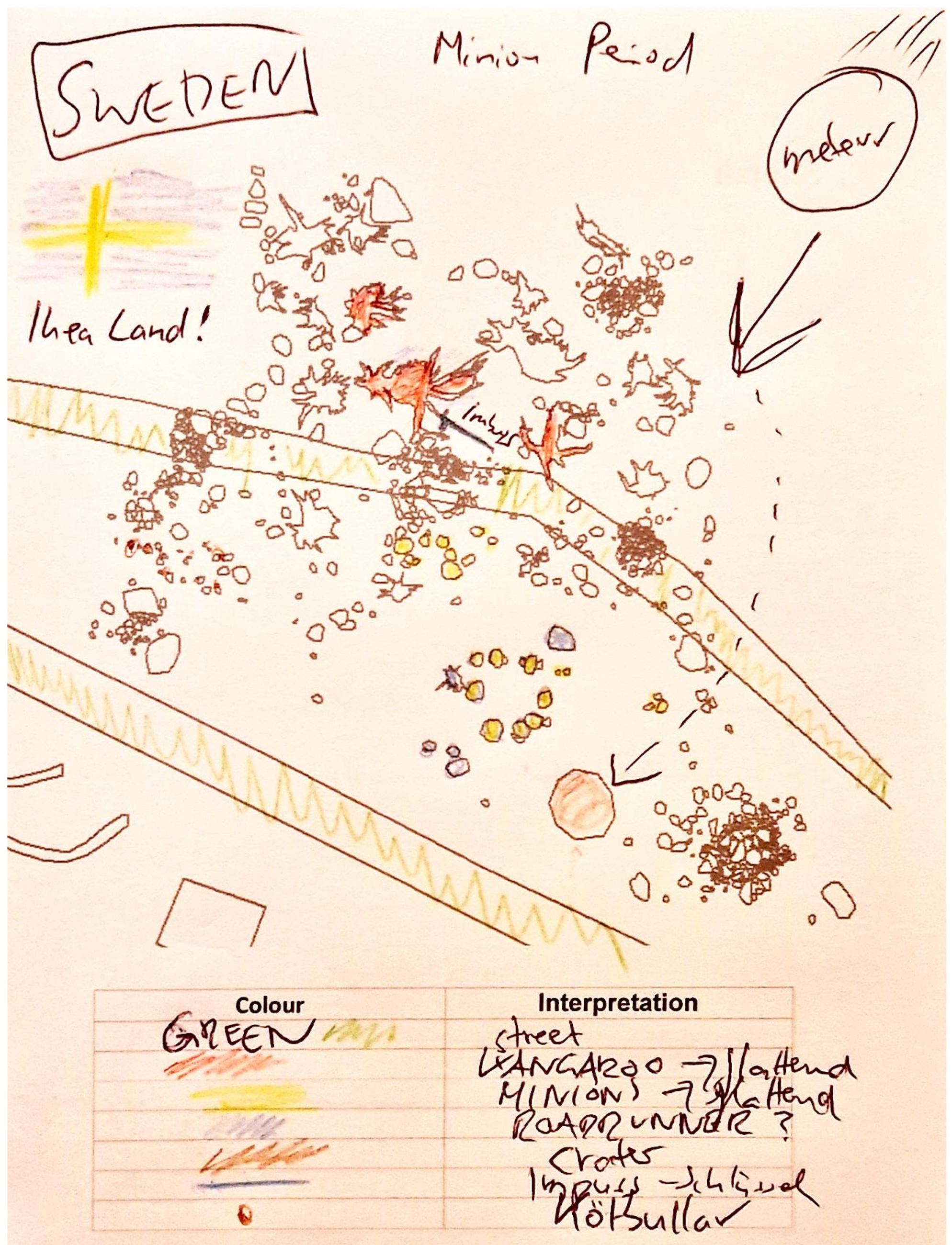
## Once upon a time in FAIRyland...

… somewhere in the misty lands north of the Baltic, during the fabled Minion Period (ca. 3000-2000 BCE), a fiery rock fell from the heavens. When it struck the ground, the earth shook, carving a glittering crater that would later become the heart of a curious civilisation. The locals called it simply the Impact — and around it, life began to hum with yellow energy.

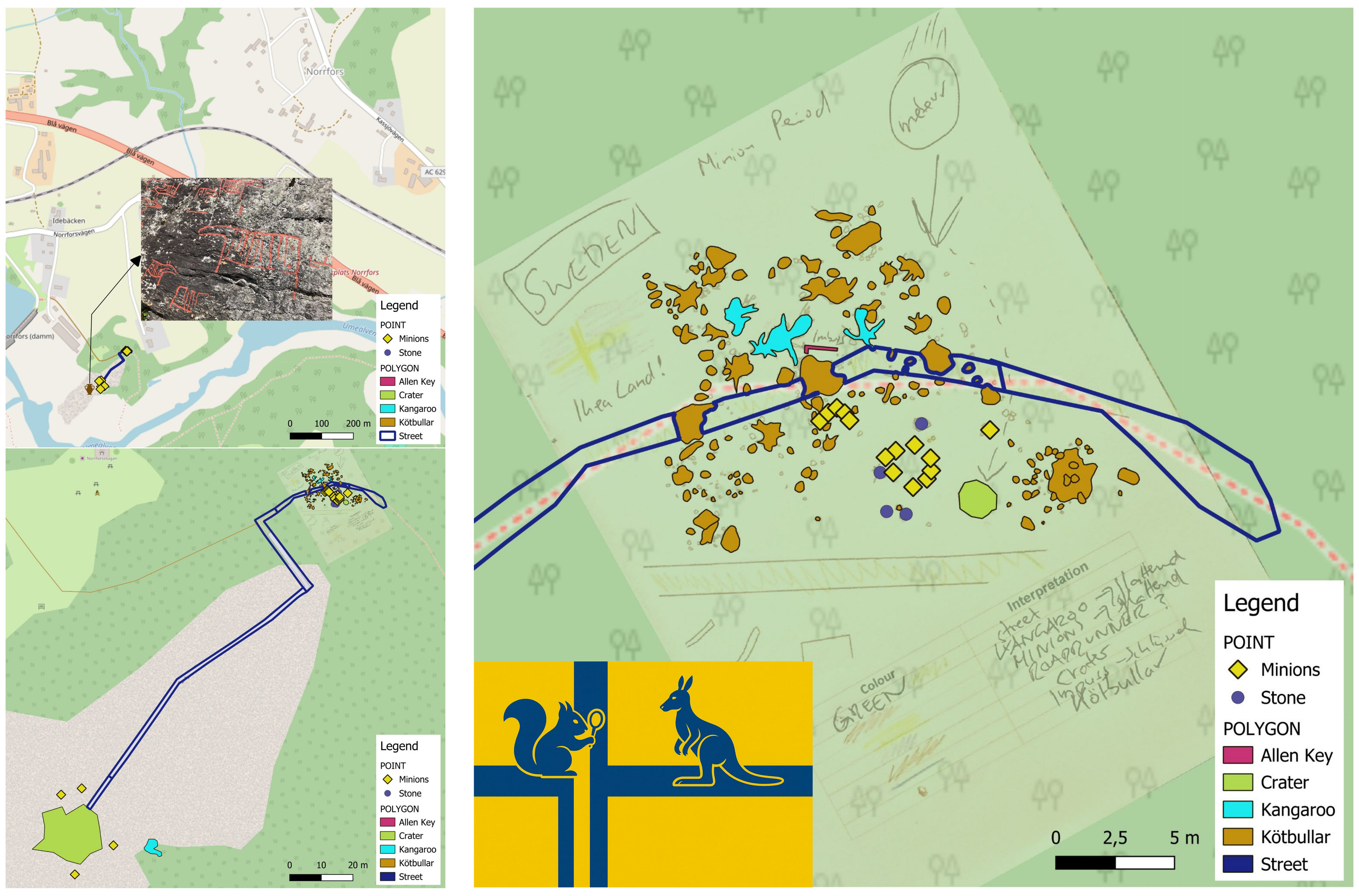
Archaeologists exploring the area centuries later uncovered the remains of Ikea Land, where a giant Allen key, forged in unknown alloys, lay half-buried in the moss. They also found traces of Minions, the small, industrious beings said to have inhabited these northern forests, working side by side with gentle giant kangaroos — perhaps as builders, perhaps as friends. Scattered among the ruins were strange spherical artefacts, which early scholars mistook for celestial stones but were, in truth, Kötbullar: petrified excrements of the ancient kangaroos.

Ancient tracks and circular walls hinted at early settlements — a network of roads and dwellings spread across the landscape like veins of memory. Around them roamed reindeer and elk, drawn to the mineral-rich soils of the crater, while shimmering auroras danced above, preserving the legend of a world where data and dreams once met.

And so, FAIRyland was born — not from stone or soil, but from the imagination of those who believe that even mythical places can teach us how to make knowledge Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable.




## Mapping the Minion Period – Georeferencing in FAIRyland




The rediscovery of FAIRyland began with a simple map — a coloured field sketch found north of the Baltic, in the forests near Norrfors, where the Rock Art of Norrfors lies carved into ancient bedrock (OSM Node 1716194356, 63.879173° N, 20.024960° E).

Archaeologists exploring these petroglyphs stumbled upon a curious drawing depicting a crater, strange settlements and, most surprisingly, the outlines of a vast territory labelled “Ikea Land.” Intrigued, researchers decided to georeference the sketch using QGIS, aligning it precisely with the coordinates of the surrounding landscape.

Once adjusted to the digital grid, each feature was digitised as a vector layer: roads and fortifications as lines, the meteor crater as a polygon, scattered artefacts and sites as points. Every element was given attributes — from “Minion” and “Imbus key” to “Stones,” “Street,” “Kangaroo,” and even “Kötbullar.”

Through this process, FAIRyland transformed from imagination into open geospatial data, fully editable, exportable, and ready for analysis. Using nothing but the open-source power of QGIS, a hand-drawn map became a teaching tool for spatial documentation, projection, and metadata management — a bridge between storytelling and spatial science.

Thus, the mythical lands of the Minion Period found their digital coordinates, rooted not in fantasy alone, but in the rocky landscapes of northern Sweden — where real petroglyphs meet imaginary data to teach the next generation of digital archaeologists.

## From Crater to Graph – Linked Open Data in FAIRyland

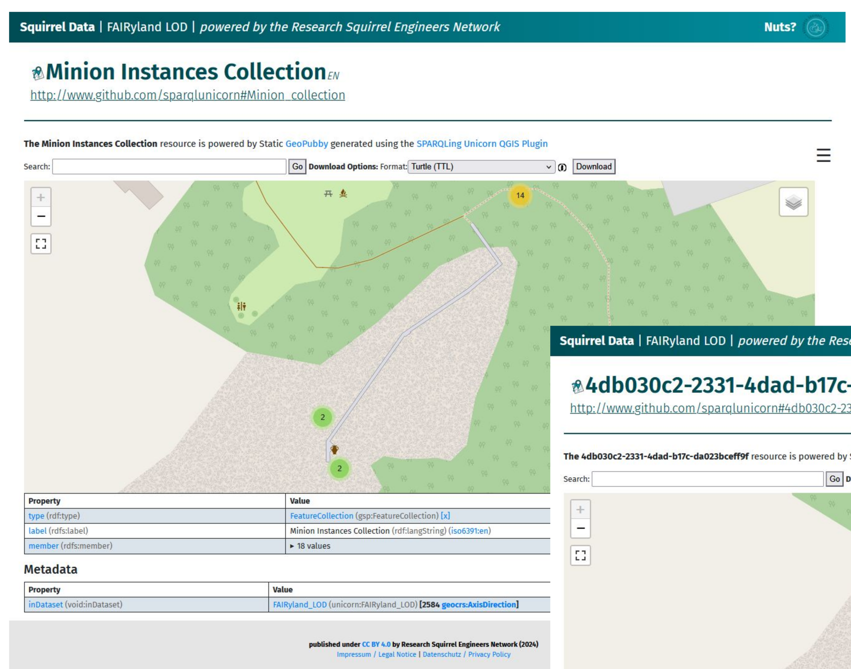
Once FAIRyland’s map had been drawn and its coordinates aligned, the scholars sought to make the data speak across worlds. For this, they turned to the magic of Linked Open Data.

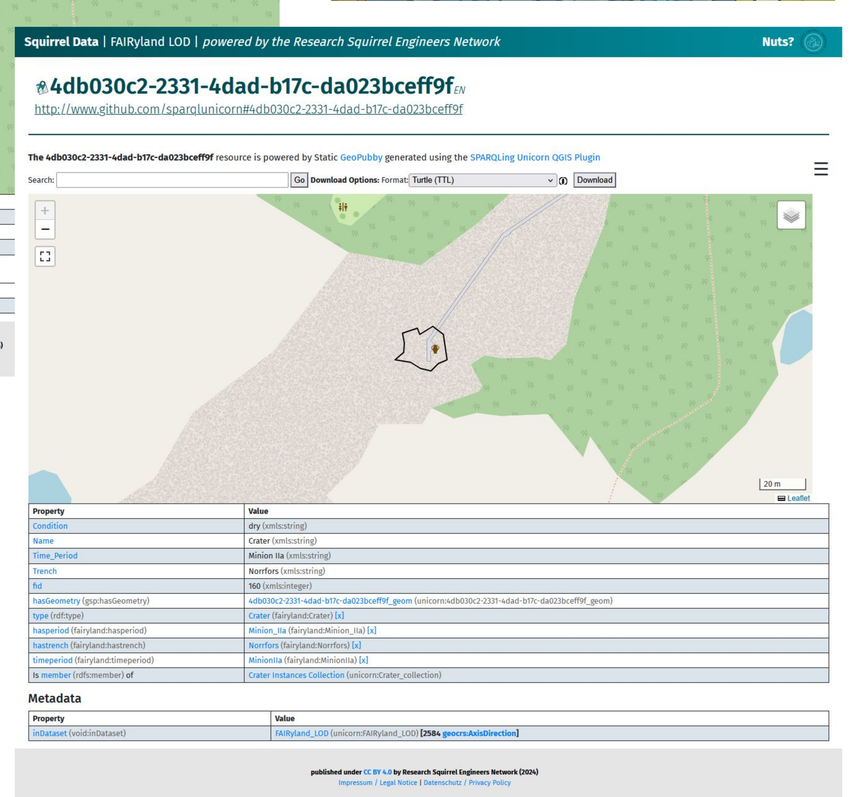
Using the SPARQLing Unicorn QGIS Plugin, every vector layer — craters, streets, Kötbullar and all — was transformed into RDF. Each feature gained a semantic identity, ready to live within the great web of connections. A gentle Python script then refined the triples, polishing prefixes, aligning vocabularies and weaving relations among entities.

The data was published through the SPARQL Unicorn Ontology Documentation Tool, generating interactive web pages on GitHub Pages — shimmering portals where code and narrative intertwine. Here, users can browse FAIRyland’s ontology, follow SPARQL queries and see how fictional archaeology becomes structured knowledge.

Through LODification, FAIRyland and Ikea Land are now poised to interact with the Norrfors Rock Art dataset, letting petroglyphs and playful Minions share one knowledge graph. Spatial traces of imagination merge with real archaeology, revealing how FAIR principles can unite datasets across domains.

In this enchanted framework, every polygon tells a story, every URI leads to discovery — and even in the far north, where reindeer still wander beneath auroras, data becomes part of a greater constellation of knowledge.




### Literature

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Find FAIRyland on Github

Find the LOD-WebGIS of FAIRyland